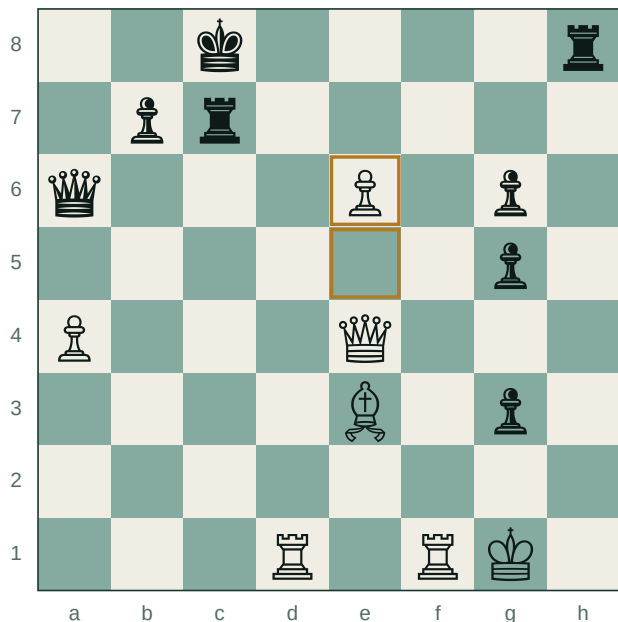


Exposed-king tactics: Black, move 30

Exposed-king tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 30.e6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

30...Qe2 31. Rd2 Rh1+ 32. Qxh1 Qxe3+ 33. Kg2 Qxd2+

30...Qe2 The queen moves from a6 to e2. From e2 it attacks rook on f1, rook on d1 and bishop on e3. Recorded reply: **31.Rd2**.

31...Rh1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **32.Qxh1**.

32...Qxe3+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From e3 it attacks king on g1 and rook on d2. Recorded reply: **33.Kg2**.

33...Qxd2+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on d2.

At the end, nominal material is White 16 / Black 18 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A king without pawns is not automatically mated. Count active attackers and examine escapes toward friendly pieces.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An exposed king gives the attacker checks and access to nearby squares. Coordinate pieces so the checks drive it into a worse net rather than toward safety.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect open files, diagonals, and unprotected squares around the king. Calculate checks in an order that preserves the attack.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on e4. Check for tactical protection.